Module 05 Lab - Data PreparationObjective: To learn and apply the most common data preparation techniques. Raw data is rarely ready for a machine learning model. This process, also called preprocessing, is one of the most critical steps in the entire ML workflow.In this lab, you will write more of the code. Read the explanations and then complete the tasks in the code cells.

Part 1: Setup and Initial LookWe will continue using the Titanic dataset because it has the exact problems we need to solve: missing values and non-numeric data.

In [ ]:
```
import pandas as pd
import numpy as np

# Load the dataset
df =
pd.read_csv('https://raw.githubusercontent.com/datasciencedojo/datasets/master/titanic.csv')

# Let's look at the missing values
print("--- Missing Values Before Cleaning ---")
print(df.isnull().sum())
```

```
--- Missing Values Before Cleaning ---
PassengerId      0
Survived         0
Pclass           0
Name             0
Sex              0
Age            177
SibSp            0
Parch            0
Ticket           0
Fare             0
Cabin          687
Embarked         2
dtype: int64
```

Part 2: Handling Missing Values (Imputation)Concept: Most machine learning models cannot handle missing values (`NaN`).

We must deal with them. Dropping the rows is an option, but you lose data. A better way is imputation, which means filling in the missing values with a calculated guess.Common imputation strategies:* Mean: Fill with the average value. Good for normally distributed data.* Median: Fill with the middle value. Better for skewed data or data with outliers (like `Fare`).* Mode: Fill with the most frequent value. Used for categorical data.

Task 1: Impute the 'Age' ColumnThe 'Age' column is missing many values. Since age can be skewed (e.g., by a few very old passengers), using the median is a robust choice.Your Task: Calculate the median of the 'Age' column and use the `.fillna()` method to replace the missing values.

In [6]:
```
# 1. Calculate the median of the 'Age' column
median_age = df['Age'].median()

# 2. Fill the missing values in 'Age' with the median
df['Age'] = df['Age'].fillna(median_age)

# 3. Verify that there are no more missing values in 'Age'
print("Missing values in 'Age' after imputation:")
print(df['Age'].isnull().sum())
```

```
Missing values in 'Age' after imputation:
0
```

Part 3: Encoding Categorical FeaturesConcept: Machine learning models are mathematical, so they need numbers, not text. We need to convert categorical columns (like 'Sex' and 'Embarked') into a numerical format. The most common method is One-Hot Encoding.One-Hot Encoding takes a column with `N` categories and turns it into `N` new columns, each with a `1` or `0`. For example, the 'Sex' column (`male`, `female`) becomes two new columns: `Sex_male` and

`Sex_female` .Pandas has a convenient function called `pd.get_dummies()` that does this for us.

Task 2: One-Hot Encode Categorical ColumnsYour Task: Use `pd.get_dummies()` to encode the 'Sex' and 'Embarked' columns. Make sure to drop the original columns after encoding.

In [7]:
```
# 1. Use get_dummies to create new columns for 'Sex' and 'Embarked'
#    Set `drop_first=True` to avoid multicollinearity
encoded_df = pd.get_dummies(df, columns=['Sex', 'Embarked'],
drop_first=True)

# 2. Display the first few rows of the new DataFrame to see the new columns
display(encoded_df.head())
```

Columns 1–8 of 14

	PassengerId	Survived	Pclass	Name	Age	SibSp	Parch
0	1	0	3	Braund, Mr. Owen Harris	22.0	1	0
1	2	1	1	Cumings, Mrs. John Bradley (Florence Briggs Th...	38.0	1	0
2	3	1	3	Heikkinen, Miss. Laina	26.0	0	0
3	4	1	1	Futrelle, Mrs. Jacques Heath (Lily May Peel)	35.0	1	0
4	5	0	3	Allen, Mr. William Henry	35.0	0	0

Columns 9–14 of 14 · first column repeated

	Ticket	Fare	Cabin	Sex_male	Embarked_Q	Embarked_S
0	A/5 21171	7.2500	NaN	True	False	True
1	PC 17599	71.2833	C85	False	False	False
2	STON/O2. 3101282	7.9250	NaN	False	False	True
3	113803	53.1000	C123	False	False	True
4	373450	8.0500	NaN	True	False	True

Part 4: Feature ScalingConcept: Many models are sensitive to the scale of the features. For example, `Age` (from 0-80) and

`Fare` (from 0-512) are on very different scales. This can cause the model to incorrectly believe that `Fare` is a more important feature simply because its values are larger.Feature Scaling solves this by putting all features on a similar scale. A common method is Standardization (`StandardScaler` in scikit-learn), which rescales the data to have a mean of 0 and a standard deviation of 1.Important: You only scale your numerical features, not your target variable or your newly encoded categorical columns.

Task 3: Scale the 'Age' and 'Fare' ColumnsYour Task: Use `StandardScaler`

from `sklearn.preprocessing` to scale the 'Age' and 'Fare' columns.

In [8]:
```
from sklearn.preprocessing import StandardScaler

# 1. Create an instance of the StandardScaler
scaler = StandardScaler()

# 2. Select the columns to scale
columns_to_scale = ['Age', 'Fare']

# 3. Fit the scaler to the data and transform it
encoded_df[columns_to_scale] =
scaler.fit_transform(encoded_df[columns_to_scale])

# 4. Display the first few rows to see the scaled data
display(encoded_df.head())
```

Columns 1–8 of 14

	PassengerId	Survived	Pclass	Name	Age	SibSp	Parch
0	1	0	3	Braund, Mr. Owen Harris	-0.565736	1	0
1	2	1	1	Cumings, Mrs. John Bradley (Florence Briggs Th...	0.663861	1	0
2	3	1	3	Heikkinen, Miss. Laina	-0.258337	0	0
3	4	1	1	Futrelle, Mrs. Jacques Heath (Lily May Peel)	0.433312	1	0
4	5	0	3	Allen, Mr. William Henry	0.433312	0	0

Columns 9–14 of 14 · first column repeated

	Ticket	Fare	Cabin	Sex_male	Embarked_Q	Embarked_S
0	A/5 21171	-0.502445	NaN	True	False	True
1	PC 17599	0.786845	C85	False	False	False
2	STON/O2. 3101282	-0.488854	NaN	False	False	True
3	113803	0.420730	C123	False	False	True
4	373450	-0.486337	NaN	True	False	True

📝 Knowledge CheckInstructions: Answer the following questions in this markdown cell.1. **Why is it often better to impute missing values with the median instead of the mean? **2. **Explain in your own words what One-Hot Encoding does and why it is necessary.**3. Would you need to apply Feature Scaling to a Decision Tree model? Why or why not? (Hint: Think about how a Decision Tree makes its splits).

1. The median is often better because it is less affected by outliers. The median is especially useful when the data is skewed.
2. One-Hot Encoding turns categories into separate numerical columns. This lets models use categorical information without implying an order.
3. No, a decision tree generally does not need feature scaling. It splits data using thresholds within individual features.